



FAMILY NAME

MRN

GIVEN NAMES

SEX ☐ MALE ☐ FEMALE

D.O.B. ____ / ____ / ____

M.O.

Service _____

ADDRESS

LOCATION

COMPLETE ALL DETAILS OR AFFIX PATIENT LABEL HERE

Mental Health Abnormal Involuntary Movement Scale (AIMS)

EXAMINATION PROCEDURE*

Either before or after completing the examination procedure observe the patient unobtrusively at rest (e.g. in waiting room). The chair to be used in this examination should be a hard, firm one without arms

- Ask patient whether there is anything in his/her mouth (i.e. chewing gum, etc.)
- Ask patient about the current condition of his/her teeth. Ask patient if he/she wears dentures. Do teeth/dentures bother patient now?
- Ask patient whether he/she notices any movements in mouth, face, hands, or feet. If yes, ask to describe and to what extent they currently bother patient or interfere with his/her activities.
- Have patient sit in chair with hands on knees, legs slightly apart and feet flat on floor. Look at entire body for movements while in this position.
- Ask patient to sit with hands hanging unsupported. If male, between legs, if female and wearing a dress, hanging over knees. Observe hands and other body areas.
- Ask patient to open mouth. Observe tongue at rest within mouth. Do this twice.
- Ask patient to protrude tongue. Observe abnormalities of tongue movement. Do this twice.
- Ask patient to tap thumb, with each finger, as rapidly as possible for 10-15 seconds, separately with right hand, then with left hand. Observe facial and leg movements. Flex and extend patients left and right arms, one at a time. Note any rigidity and rate.
- Ask patient to stand up. Observe in profile. Observe all body areas again, hips included.
- Ask patients to extend both arms outstretched in front with palms down. Observe trunk, legs and mouth.
- Have patient walk a few paces, turn, and walk back to chair. Observe hands and gait. Do this twice.

** Activated movements

Rate highest severity observed. Rate movements that occur upon activation one less than those observed spontaneously. Circle movement, as well as rating score, that applies.

Rating score: 0 = none 1 = minimal 2 = mild 3 = moderate 4 = severe

Facial and oral movements

Muscles of facial expression

0 1 2 3 4

Jaw

0 1 2 3 4

Lips and perioral area

0 1 2 3 4

Tongue

0 1 2 3 4

Extremity movements

Upper (arms, wrists, hands, fingers)

0 1 2 3 4

Lower (legs, knees, ankles, toes)

0 1 2 3 4

Trunk movements

Neck, shoulders, hips

0 1 2 3 4

AIMS SUBTOTAL

Global judgements

Severity of abnormal movements overall

0 1 2 3 4

Patient's awareness of abnormal movements

0 1 2 3 4

Incapacitation due to abnormal movements

0 1 2 3 4

Dental status

Current problems with teeth and/or dentures

Yes ☐ No ☐

Edentia

Yes ☐ No ☐

Are dentures usually worn

Yes ☐ No ☐

Movements disappear in sleep

Yes ☐ No ☐

Comments (consider abnormal tone / evidence of akathisia)

*Source: Physical Health Care of Mental Health Consumers (NSW Health, 2017)

Medical Practitioner name:

Signature:

Designation:

Date:

Qualifications: